

SENATE JOINT RESOLUTION 880

By Massey

A RESOLUTION to honor and congratulate Black Dog Fitness and owner Zach Guza, recipient of the Business Award at the 24th Annual John J. Duncan Sr. Awards for Senior Advocacy.

WHEREAS, it is fitting that the members of this General Assembly should salute those exemplary businesses and their owners, who, through their extraordinary efforts, have distinguished themselves as community leaders of whom we can all be proud; and

WHEREAS, one such exceptional business is Black Dog Fitness, owned by Zach Guza, which has been named the winner of the Business Award at the 24th Annual John J. Duncan Sr. Awards for Senior Advocacy; and

WHEREAS, the John J. Duncan Sr. Awards for Senior Advocacy were established to honor those individuals and businesses who embody the legacy of the late U.S. Representative John J. Duncan, Sr., who was an advocate for older adults in the Second Congressional District of the State of Tennessee; and

WHEREAS, a local boxing gym just for people with Parkinson's disease, Black Dog Fitness was founded by Zach Guza, a personal trainer, who launched the business from his garage as a private personal training program to help his clients fight anxiety and depression with exercise; and

WHEREAS, after learning about the benefits of exercise for people with Parkinson's disease, Mr. Guza started Rock Steady Boxing-Knoxville in 2016 in honor of his father, Sam Guza, who died with Parkinson's disease; and

WHEREAS, ten years later, Black Dog Fitness has its own location with over 170 members, six coaches, seven different exercise programs, a YouTube channel with over 4,000 subscribers, and twenty-two weekly classes; and

WHEREAS, Zach Guza is a graduate of the United States Air Force Academy and served as a helicopter pilot in the U.S. Air Force for nine years; after the military, he worked in civilian manufacturing before deciding to make a career for himself in the fitness industry, having realized that exercise as his self-therapy had probably saved his life after being diagnosed with depression; and

WHEREAS, his many professional accomplishments aside, Mr. Guza is most thankful for the love and support of his devoted wife, Jenny, and their wonderful sons, Brice and Blair; and

WHEREAS, Mr. Guza, through his efforts at Black Dog Fitness, has worked tirelessly to serve seniors in his community, and it is most fitting that he be honored; now, therefore,

BE IT RESOLVED BY THE SENATE OF THE ONE HUNDRED FOURTEENTH GENERAL ASSEMBLY OF THE STATE OF TENNESSEE, THE HOUSE OF REPRESENTATIVES CONCURRING, that we honor and congratulate Black Dog Fitness and owner Zach Guza upon receiving the Business Award at the 24th Annual John J. Duncan Sr. Awards for Senior Advocacy, extending our best wishes for much continued success in the years to come.

BE IT FURTHER RESOLVED, that an appropriate copy of this resolution be prepared for presentation with this final clause omitted from such copy and upon proper request made to the appropriate clerk, the language appearing immediately following the State seal appear without House or Senate designation.